Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Sunday, 8 November 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Overcast	Overcast	Light drizzle	Overcast
11° 7°	10° 6°	10° 7°	10° 7°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **UK cannot 'cherry pick' EU single market deal, Barnier tells BBC.**
The former Brexit negotiator says EU countries would reject any British attempts to follow economic rules "a la carte".
UK · NEWS

2 **Victims in rape cases must not feel like they are on trial, Burnham says.**
The PM was responding after a police chief said comments made during Russell Brand's trial came close to "victim blaming".
UK · NEWS

3 **Two men arrested after boy injured in sword attack.**
A 17-year-old boy from Gloucester has also been arrested on suspicion of assisting an offender.
UK · NEWS

4 **Relief, tears and sadness: Married at First Sight UK cast react to show being axed.**
The show was cancelled after a BBC Panorama investigation heard allegations from three former cast members.
UK · NEWS

5 **We thought mum abandoned us - then we discovered she'd been murdered.**
The children of Patricia Lashley grew up believing their mother had abandoned them.
UK · NEWS

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02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Monty Don bids 'final goodbye' to Gardeners' World after two decades.**
The head gardener on the long-running BBC TV series signed off from Longmeadow garden on Friday.
SHOWBIZ · UK

2 **Relief, tears and sadness: Married at First Sight UK cast react to show being axed.**
The show was cancelled after a BBC Panorama investigation heard allegations from three former cast members.
SHOWBIZ · UK

3 **Gladiator II stuntman sues over injuries from on-set explosion.**
Edward Sarsfield says he suffered "excruciating" burns while filming a scene on a burning ship.
SHOWBIZ · UK

4 **Knicks defend Taylor Swift after players name her 'fakest celebrity fan'.**
The pop superstar's appearances at NBA games were deemed "a little performative" by New York Knicks point guards Tyler Kolek and Miles McBride.
SHOWBIZ · UK

5 **An Indian film that nobody would release is finally a hit - 18 awards later.**
Extraordinary scenes of audiences crying leaving theatres after watching the film have been shared on social media.
SHOWBIZ · UK

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Ruthless All Blacks blow Scotland away in second half.**
New Zealand canter to a 43-21 Nations Championship win at Murrayfield as Scotland fall away after a thrilling first half.
SPORT · UK

2 **Tottenham set to complain to Pro Ref - but should Bogle have seen red?.**
Tottenham are set to submit a formal complaint about the decision not to send off Jayden Bogle for his challenge on Mathys Tel during the defeat by Leeds.
SPORT · UK

3 **Goal caps eye-catching Odegaard display - player ratings for Arsenal v Hull.**
How Arsenal and Hull City's players rated following their Premier League match at Emirates Stadium.
SPORT · UK

4 **Highlights: Non-league Kidderminster shock League One Doncaster.**
National League Kidderminster shock League One Doncaster to progress to the second round of the FA Cup.
SPORT · UK

5 **Powell and Phillips star as Bradford put seven past Marine.**
Nick Powell and Adam Phillips both score a brace as Bradford City hammer National League North side Marine 7-0 in the first round of the FA Cup.
SPORT · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **Almost 70% of UK households now have a smart speaker — but the most common use is still 'asking what time it is'.**
Researchers say we under-use the devices we own. Setting timers, playing music and weather queries make up two thirds of all commands.

2 **Tinned fish is unexpectedly trendy again, with younger shoppers leading the charge.**
Sardines and mackerel are being repackaged as a quick, cheap protein. Older shoppers are quietly baffled, having eaten it for decades.

3 **Local 'repair cafés', where volunteers fix broken items for free, are spreading across the UK.**
Toasters, lamps and zips are the most common patients. Organisers say the biggest barrier is convincing people their old kettle is worth saving.

4 **A study finds the average person has a 'comfort route' they walk or drive even when there's a faster way.**
Familiarity, not speed, wins. We'd rather the known road with the nice tree than save three minutes on the ring road.

5 **A study says the average person walks past their phone over 50 times a day without picking it up.**
Researchers reckon just seeing it nearby is enough reassurance. The phone, meanwhile, remains entirely unbothered.

6 **Allotment waiting lists have hit record highs across the UK.**
Councils in some areas now quote waits of several years. The most-grown first crop for beginners? Courgettes — closely followed by regret, as they produce far too many.

7 **A survey finds most of us have at least one app we've never opened since downloading it.**
The average phone reportedly carries dozens of unused apps. Top of the 'meant to use it' pile: language-learning and meditation.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Over half of us confess we've kept a gift we hated because of THIS.**

ANSWER: GUILT THAT THE GIVER MIGHT VISIT AND NOTICE IT'S GONE.

Q **The most common thing we do in a lift is apparently THIS.**

ANSWER: STARE AT THE NUMBERS AS IF THEY'RE ENTHRALLING.

TALK TOPIC

- **A study claims the song you loved at 14 is the one you'll love forever.**
  What was yours — and are you brave enough to admit it on air?
- **Most people apparently have one job they wanted as a child and completely abandoned.**
  What did you want to be? And how far did real life take you from it?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Records.** The shortest commercial flight in the world runs between two Scottish islands, Westray and Papa Westray, and can take under two minutes with a good tailwind.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A seaside town has installed Britain's first 'reverse' pier — a walkway that goes inland from the beach, after planners admitted they'd read the blueprints upside down.

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06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A blue whale's tongue alone weighs as much as an elephant.
- Octopuses can taste with their suckers.
- Wales has more castles per square mile than any other country in the world.
- Bananas grow upside down.
- Your nose can detect over a trillion different scents.
- The unicorn is the national animal of Scotland.
- There are more trees on Earth than stars in the Milky Way.
- A snail can sleep for three years at a time.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES SUN 8 NOV 2026

On this day

Day 312 of the year, 53 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Blessed Elisabetta Maria Satellico; Christian feast day: Four Crowned Martyrs; Christian feast day: Godfrey of Amiens; Christian feast day: Johann von Staupitz (Lutheran). Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Topaz.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1994 — Lauren Alaina, American singer and songwriter
- 1968 — Parker Posey, American actress
- 1980 — Holly Walsh, English radio and television host
- 1993 — Fraser Mullen, Scottish footballer
- 1963 — Paul McKenna, English hypnotist and author
- 2000 — Jasmine Thompson, English singer
- 1983 — Nikola Rachelle, English-New Zealand singer-songwriter and producer
- 1974 — Matthew Rhys, Welsh actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 1994 — Republican Revolution: On the night of the 1994 United States midterm elections, Republicans make historic electoral gains by securing massive majorities in both houses of Congress (54 seats in the House and eight seats in the Senate, additionally), thus bringing to a close fo...
- 2020 — Myanmar holds the 2020 general election, re-electing a government led by the National League for Democracy, which is deposed by the Burmese military the following February during the 2021 Myanmar coup d'état.
- 1965 — The British Indian Ocean Territory is created, consisting of Chagos Archipelago, Aldabra, Farquhar and Des Roches islands.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1973 — The right ear of John Paul Getty III is delivered to a newspaper outlet along with a ransom note, convincing his father to pay US$2.9 million.
- 1968 — The Vienna Convention on Road Traffic is signed to facilitate international road traffic and to increase road safety by standardising the uniform traffic rules among the signatories.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1965 — The 173rd Airborne is ambushed by over 1,200 Viet Cong in Operation Hump during the Vietnam War, while the 1st Battalion, Royal Australian Regiment fight one of the first set-piece engagements of the war between Australian forces and the Viet Cong at the Battle of Gang Toi.
- 2013 — Typhoon Haiyan, one of the strongest tropical cyclones ever recorded, strikes the Visayas region of the Philippines; the storm left at least 6,340 people dead with over 1,000 still missing, and caused $2.86 billion (2013 USD; equivalent to $3.95 billion in 2025) in damage.
- 1997 — Eritrea adopts the nakfa as its official currency.

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09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES MON 9 NOV 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 313 of the year, 52 days left in 2026. Today no major UK observance listed. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Topaz.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

THE DAY TOMORROW

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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